App Service, to IIS, to an FTP site, or to a folder on the local machine.

From here, you can publish your application directly from Visual Studio to many locations. This is great when you're getting started, though I recommend looking at a more automated and controlled approach when you have a larger application or a whole team working on a single app.

TIP For guidance on choosing your Visual Studio publishing options, see Microsoft's "Deploy your app to a folder, IIS, Azure, or another destination" documentation at http://mng.bz/4Z8j.

Given the number of possibilities available in this space and the speed with which these options change, I'm going to focus on one specific scenario in this chapter: you've built an ASP.NET Core application, and you need to deploy it. You have access to a Windows server that's already serving legacy .NET Framework ASP.NET applications using IIS, and you want to run your ASP.NET Core app alongside them.

In the next section you'll see an overview of the steps required to run an ASP.NET Core application in production, using IIS as a reverse proxy. It won't be a master class in configuring IIS (there's so much depth to the 25-year-old product that I wouldn't know where to start!), but I'll cover the basics needed to get your application serving requests.

27.2 Publishing your app to IIS

In this section I briefly show you how to publish your first app to IIS. You'll add an application pool and website to IIS and ensure that your app has the necessary configuration to work with IIS as a reverse proxy. The deployment itself will be as simple as copying your published app to IIS's hosting folder.